



CATESOL San Diego Chapter Spring 2024 Conference

“FOSTERING A COMMUNITY OF LEARNERS IN THE
CLASSROOMS AND BEYOND”



SATURDAY, APRIL 27 8.30AM-1.30PM

**American Language Institute
SDSU Global Campus
5250 Campanile Dr.
San Diego, CA 92182**

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 CATESOL San Diego Chapter

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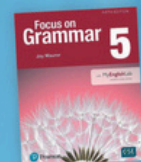


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Visit our booth at CATESOL San Diego Chapter Spring Conference
Contact us: Cristiane da Silva, M.A. TESOL.
ELT/ELL Key Account Manager, California
cristiane.dasilva@pearson.com



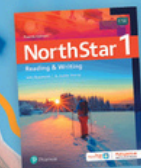
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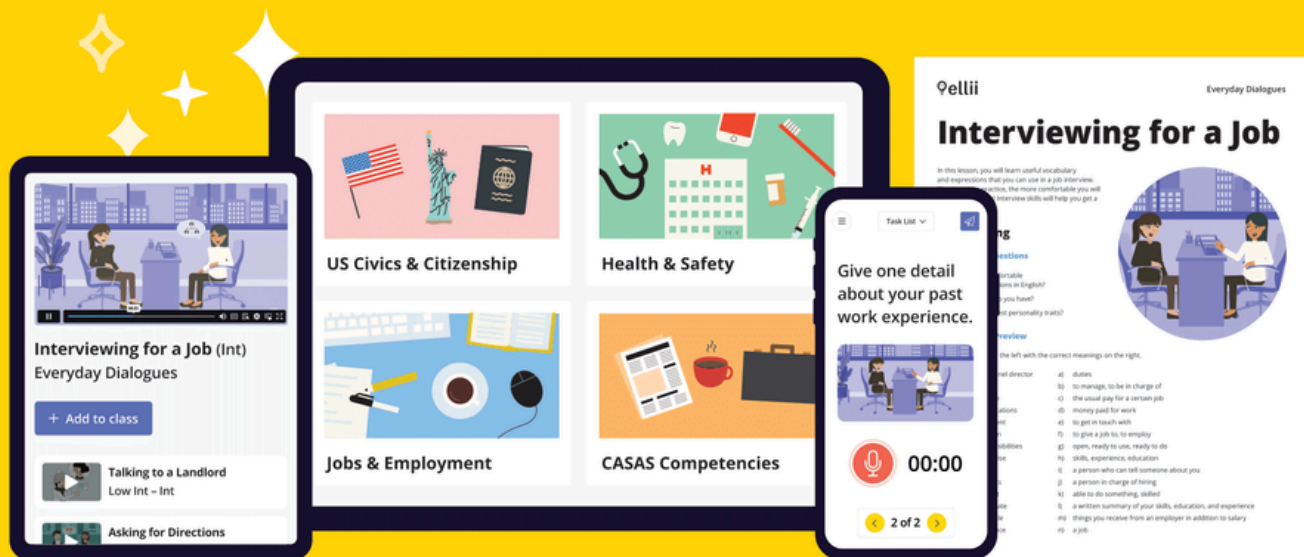
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PROGRAM

8:30AM - 9:30AM

Registration

Refreshments

Welcome messages

9:30AM - 10:00AM

Plenary Talk

10:15AM - 11:00AM

Session 1

11:15AM - 12:00PM

Session 2

12:15PM - 1:00PM

Session 3

1:00PM - 1:30PM

Networking

Refreshments

Drawings

Closing Remarks

PLENARY SPEAKER: ROOMS 206/208

INGRID SBACCHI BAIRSTOW

9.30am-10.00am

Associate Professor, Full-time, ESL Credit & Noncredit
Imperial Valley College
ingrid.bairstow@imperial.edu

Ingrid Sbacchi Bairstow has fostered communication all her life in different languages (Italian, Swedish and French), different careers (journalism, non-governmental organizations in Africa and Eastern Europe), and various hobbies such as hiking, anthropology, and paddleboarding. She found her tribe and her calling as an ESL instructor in Hong Kong, MiraCosta College, San Diego College of Continuing Education, and most recently as Associate Professor at Imperial Valley College in Imperial County. She is passionate about creating opportunities to collaborate with colleagues and students to create ways to communicate- whether it's on a mountain top, beach clean-up, or in a classroom.



Education: BA English from Atlantic Union College, Massachusetts; MA Social Science, Stockholm University; MA TESOL, Alliant International University

Plenary Session Abstract

The Power and Evolution of Community: A Reflection and a Call to Evolve

You know it when you see it. A class gels. Student motivation and success is high. Colleagues seek each other for unpaid happy hours to share teaching ideas. Both examples include laughter and joy. These are examples of the power of community. Unfortunately, the rise of online, hybrid, and even in-person workplaces and classrooms is creeping into time allotted for motivational and enjoyable community-building activities. Efforts to 'humanize' these places are crucial.

In this plenary talk, we will reflect on the growing extinction of traditional community activities and how we can co-evolve with the future of how we educate and collaborate. There's a renaissance in education, with brand-new places for communities that did not previously exist. Participants will reflect on examples of successful ways to create community in the past and brainstorm communication strategies for the future classroom, 'hallway,' and beyond.

SESSION 1: 10.15AM-11.00AM

JOHANNA GLEASON, SDCCE

ROOM 209

Teaching Literacy to Absolute Beginners

How do you teach people to read and write if they can't speak or understand English? The presenter will share tips, techniques, and lesson plans. One of the key components of success is building a class community where the students get to know, help, trust, and respect one another. Attendees will leave this session with an understanding of the process and a variety of techniques and activities they can use in their own beginner level classes.

CHRIS STILLWELL, SADDLEBACK COLLEGE &
UC IRVINE & US DEPT OF STATE'S ENGLISH
LANGUAGE PROGRAMS

ROOM 210

All's Well That Begins Well: Best Ways to Begin Courses

When it comes to teaching a class effectively, the wisdom about beginnings is probably true: The beginning may indeed be "the most important part of the work" (Plato). This session explores this rich, important topic from many angles, drawing from the presenter's work on projects with the Department of State's English Language Programs. Participants will come away with a variety of new ways to start courses on the right path, including (1) reaching out to students prior to the start of a course, in a way that builds interest and fosters success, (2) building a cohesive classroom community from day one, and (3) setting expectations and establishing routines that will promote success throughout the course.

KRISTI REYES, OTAN & MIRACOSTA COLLEGE

ROOM 211

Projects Allowing Creative Expression with Technology Generate Confidence and Joy

Have you ever observed a quiet student transform into a confident language user through the integration of arts or technology? Research indicates that activities and assignments giving students opportunities to express themselves creatively result in more effective and enduring learning and increased student motivation. Attend this presentation and walk away with ideas and lesson plans you can modify for your student audience that use free tech tools including AI.

SESSION 2: 11.15AM-12.00PM

RYAN DETWILER, MIRACOSTA COLLEGE &
PALOMAR COLLEGE
HOLLY BELL, PALOMAR COLLEGE & SDCCE

ROOM 209

Practical Teaching Strategies to Boost Community in Beginner-Level Classrooms

In this interactive workshop, the presenters will share strategies and activities that build and strengthen classroom community in both face-to-face and online classes. Building community among beginning-level students presents unique challenges. However, it can be accomplished using simple interactive activities that have strong vocabulary and grammar support. The presenters will demonstrate a variety of student-approved techniques and activities designed to boost peer engagement in listening, speaking, reading, and writing lessons. Participants are invited to share strategies and activities that have proven successful in their own classrooms, leaving with a collection of lesson materials, games, and activities ready-to-use in upcoming classes.

ALLISON WALTER, IEC@OCC

ROOM 210

Strategies for Engaging Students in Financial Literacy and Language Development

This workshop offers dynamic approaches to engage English Language Learners in both language development and financial literacy. Workshop participants will explore a comprehensive program designed to immerse students in real-world finance, foster research skills, encourage critical thinking, and enhance language proficiency. The benefits of this course reaches beyond language and financial literacy, touching on the promotion of long-term financial planning, career opportunities, and a perspective on global economic systems. By the end, workshop participants will be well-equipped to implement this innovative approach to empower their students to navigate the intricacies of the global economy and express themselves confidently in English.

KRISTI REYES, OTAN & MIRACOSTA COLLEGE
MARIANA SILVA, MIRACOSTA COLLEGE

ROOM 211

Foster Student Connections by Reducing Cognitive Overload in LMS

ESL students enrolled in courses with asynchronous online components can be at a disadvantage if faculty don't carefully consider course navigation, organization, and accessibility. Students are learning language and digital skills while they must take on more responsibility for their own learning. The result can be cognitive overload, when "the working memory has reached full capacity and can no longer absorb information" (Piskurich, 2015). This session delves into transformative Canvas features that allow instructors to optimize the learning experience for their ESL students. Attend to explore practical strategies to alleviate cognitive overload and foster a community of online learners.

SESSION 3: 12.15PM-1.00PM

YASSIN HENNAWY, SDCCE

ROOM 209

The Impact of ChatGPT and Wordtune Integration in Our Classrooms

In today's digital age, artificial intelligence (AI) has emerged as a powerful tool with the potential to revolutionize education. Our workshop, "The Impact of ChatGPT and Wordtune Integration in our Classrooms," offers a comprehensive exploration of how AI, specifically ChatGPT and Wordtune can be integrated into English as a Second Language (ESL) and English Language Arts (ELA) classrooms, with a primary focus on enhancing students' writing skills.

KELLY METZ-MATTHEWS, SDCCE

RYANE WILLIS, SDCCE

JASON GREENO, SDCCE

JIA SUN, SDCCE

JOHANNA GLEASON, SDCCE

ROOM 210

Navigating Multiple Literacies in Adult Education Contexts: Critical Learnings from the Classroom

Literacy development encompasses more than reading and writing. Today's ESOL educators must help their students build traditional literacy in tandem with digital, visual, and cultural literacies. This expansion requires not only an enhanced set of skills and innovations on teachers' parts but also demands that teachers come to the classroom with empathy, patience, and an eye toward engaging critically and reflectively with texts, symbols, and other linguistic artifacts. This panel will explore the impact and challenges of teaching multiple literacies in the context of adult education, especially, though not solely, for refugees and asylees with limited access to resources.

MARY ANN DHUYVETTER, ALI & SDSU

ROOM 211

Best Practices in Teaching Listening and Speaking

Let's look at how we can build a classroom community in a listening and speaking class. How can we create a classroom family from Day 1, then continue to support students as they learn new material, practice and refine their skills, and reflect on their learning? I will present effective teaching strategies for each stage of lesson planning (students are presented with new material, they practice skills, and produce them independently) with a focus on supporting inter-student relationships. Attendees at this presentation will be invited to contribute their own ideas for best practices. We will conclude by creating a shared master list of recommended technological tools and websites.

LIST OF PRESENTERS



JOHANNA GLEASON

San Diego College of Continuing Education

Johanna Gleason has been teaching English to non-native speakers for over 20 years. She currently works with newcomers at San Diego College of Continuing Education where she also serves as the ESL Technology Coordinator and an Online Accessibility Mentor.



CHRIS STILLWELL

Saddleback College, UC Irvine, US Dept of State's English Language Programs

Dr. Chris Stillwell was recognized on TESOL International's 50th anniversary list of "30 Up and Coming" TESOL professionals, "the next generation in research, teaching, publishing, and leadership." As an English Language Specialist for the US Department of State's English Language Programs (ELP), he has worked on projects in Egypt, Brazil and Mexico. As an Alumni Ambassador for the ELP, he is currently promoting opportunities to teach abroad through the program. He has been a featured speaker for OC CATESOL's semi-annual workshops on several occasions. His first edited volume on Language Teaching Insights from Other Fields was shortlisted for an ELTon Award for Innovation in Teacher Resources.



KRISTI REYES

OTAN, MiraCosta College

Kristi Reyes, MA TESL, is a tenured faculty member in the noncredit ESL program at MiraCosta College, California, with more than two decades of experience teaching adults. She has taught online for more than a decade with online teaching credentials from @ONE and TESOL International. Kristi is also a subject matter expert for OTAN and trainer for CALPRO.



HOLLY BELL

Palomar College and San Diego College of Continuing Education

Kristi Reyes, MA TESL, is a tenured faculty member in the noncredit ESL program at MiraCosta College, California, with more than two decades of experience teaching adults. She has taught online for more than a decade with online teaching credentials from @ONE and TESOL International. Kristi is also a subject matter expert for OTAN and trainer for CALPRO.

LIST OF PRESENTERS



RYAN DETWILER

MiraCosta College & Palomar College

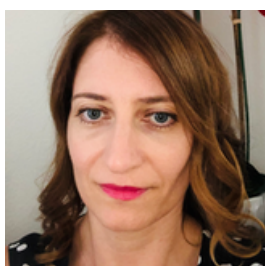
Ryan Detwiler teaches noncredit ESL at MiraCosta and Palomar Colleges, CA, and runs eslvideo.com. He has a BA in English from UCSB, a TESOL certificate from UCSB Extension, and an MFA in MPT from the AAU. He produced and licensed Short Takes Interactive to Pearson in 2007, then worked in biotech marketing until returning to teach in 2018. Ryan coordinated CATESOL's OT-IG from 2019-20 and co-coordinated CATESOL's MW-IG from 2021-23. Current Interest: Exploring AI chatbot use in ESL teaching and learning.



ALLISON WALTER

IEC@OCC

Allison Walter, M.A. Ph.D., has been teaching English and French for over 3 decades. However, her experience goes beyond teaching, spanning a variety of topics, such as filmmaking, and small business creation. She has worked in localizing and distributing video games, and has written and produced short and feature films. For her films, Allison has also worked as a social media manager, creating and managing advertising campaigns on various platforms. She has presented at conferences on various topics of French literature and philosophy as well as giving workshops on class management and the American school system. Allison has presented at past CATESOL conferences: a joint workshop with Kevin Keating on Seven Getting-To-Know Activities (Los Angeles, 2013) and Canvas (CATESOL San Diego, 2019).



MARIANA SILVA

MiraCosta College

Mariana Silva (she/her), tenured ESL faculty, has been teaching adult ESL learners at MiraCosta College, California for over ten years. Mariana has taken various classes from @ONE, has taught hybrid courses, and continuously strives to become a better online educator. Mariana is highly committed to equity, inclusion and humanizing her online courses.

LIST OF PRESENTERS



YASSIN HENNAWY

San Diego College of Continuing Education

Yassin Hennawy holds a Master's degree in English with a focus on English literature (Arizona State University), complemented by ongoing studies as a graduate student at San Diego State University General Linguistics. With a wealth of credentials including the esteemed Cambridge DELTA and CELTA certifications, he possesses a profound understanding of English language teaching methodologies. His expertise extends to neurolanguage coaching, recognized through certification in this innovative approach. A testament to his dedication and skill, he was honored with the Global Teacher Award in 2021. As a certified teacher trainer and curriculum designer, he shapes educational landscapes, fostering effective learning environments. His commitment to excellence in language education is evident in both his academic achievements and professional accolades, positioning him as a respected authority in the field. He is experienced in Teaching ELA & ESL.



KELLY METZ-MATTHEWS

San Diego College of Continuing Education

Kelly Metz-Matthews, Ph.D. is faculty and Assistant Program Chair in the English as a Second Language Program at San Diego College of Continuing Education (SDCCE). In addition to her work at SDCCE, Dr. Metz-Matthews is a 2023-2024 Stanford University EPIC Community College Faculty Fellow. She is a proud alum of the U.S. Department of State's English Language Fellow Program (Moscow, 2021) and English Language Specialist Program (Islamabad, 2023). Dr. Metz-Matthews is active within multiple state, national, and international associations. Some of her recent work can be found in CATESOL Journal, Korea TESOL Journal, COABE Journal, and Journal of Education for Students Placed at Risk.



RYANE WILLIS

San Diego College of Continuing Education

Ryane teaches as an adjunct in the English as a Second Language Department at the San Diego College of Continuing Education (SDCCE). She was the chapter coordinator of the San Diego CATESOL chapter from 2020-2022 and now serves as the social media manager. Prior to working at SDCCE, Ryane taught ESL at multiple universities in intensive English programs for academic purposes. She has master's degrees in TESOL and Global Affairs.

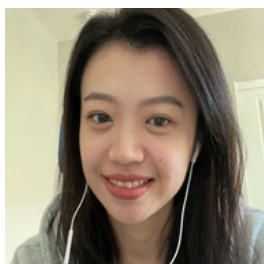
LIST OF PRESENTERS



JASON GREENO

San Diego College of Continuing Education

Jason has been working alongside students to decipher the mysteries of the English language since the birth of blue M&M's and the macarena. He's taught for multiple entities and is now extremely happy working as an adjunct for San Diego College of Continuing Education. He has a master's of education and cross-cultural teaching with specialization in linguistics studies.



JIA SUN

San Diego College of Continuing Education

Jia Sun is a full-time ESL faculty at San Diego College of Continuing Education. She has a master's degree in TESOL, Culture, and Literacy and currently teaches a fully online beginning literacy class. Jia serves as the ESL HyFlex/Digital Literacy Coordinator and the co-chair of the ESL Textbook Committee. She has presented at various conferences, including SDCCE professional development workshops, CATESOL State Conferences, CAEP Summit, and Otan TDLS.



MARY ANN DHUYVETTER

American Language Institute, SDSU

Mary Ann Dhuyvetter teaches ESL at the American Language Institute at San Diego State University. She has a Master's degree in Comparative Literature from SDSU as well as a California Single Subject credential in English and French. Her 17 years of experience include teaching English and French at the high school level, including a year as a Fulbright teaching assistant in France. Her academic focus is on building community through language and cultural studies. Her interests include cultural studies in Black and Asian American literature and the impact of Chinese culture in the 1930s in the US.

Dear Esteemed Attendee,

We want to thank you for joining us in this first in-person conference of the CATESOL San Diego Chapter since 2019, and we hope that your participation in the chapter will continue and expand to a variety of roles and events in the near future. **AND THERE'S MORE...**

*We also would like to extend our thanks to **our distinguished speakers** who contributed greatly to the conference with their vast amount of knowledge on the TESOL field and their experience in the classrooms and beyond. We could not have this conference without them!*

*Very special thanks to **our conference planning committee volunteers** who worked diligently for the conference managing and completing a variety of tasks and making this conference real:*

***Johanna Gleason**, for securing the conference venue, managing all kinds of logistics before and during, and always being ready to help us through her joyful spirit and strong connections.*

***Elizaveta Kuznetsova**, for being our Canva and promotion guru, preparing the digital banners and conference program, and joining our meetings from San Diego or Monterey with her beautiful smile and always can-do attitude.*

***Carolyn McLean**, for helping us greatly through reading, reviewing, and deciding on the proposals and making the ball start rolling with us.*

***Yassin Hennawy**, for sharing his creative ideas with us and helping us on spreading the word through social media ads.*

*We also would like to thank from the bottom of our hearts **our fellow board members:** Ryane, Lydia, Katy, and Celeste, being always available to share their expertise and insights, **the CATESOL organization** for supporting and guiding us for months, and **the day of the conference volunteers:** Adolf Schmuck, Barbara Bass, Carolyn McGavock, Celeste Coleman, Dora Lopez Espinoza, Isabel Cortes, Katy Bailey, Lydia Sparksworthy, Mary Ann Dhuyvetter, Sarah Armstrong, Stephanie Frame.*

Preparing for this conference has been such a steep learning curve, though it was also a highly rewarding and exciting journey that we are so glad that we did not miss!



***With warm regards,
Amanda Simons, Conference Chair, &
Burcu Chatham, Chapter Coordinator***

***CATESOL San Diego Chapter
#catesolsd***